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Sales Lead List 101



By **Chaz Wilke**, Staff Writer

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As a marketer there are fewer resources more valuable than your sales leads list. Much of your time is dedicated to prospecting and collecting new leads, but your efforts won't be nearly as effective without a carefully cultivated list of sales leads.

Having a contact information list for leads is integral to success as a marketer. With a well maintained sales lead list, you'll always have contacts to fall back on.

Free Sales Leads List

Starting out in a new niche may leave marketers scrambling for leads. As a means to help jumpstart a good campaign, it may be in your best interest to seek out free lists of sales leads.

There are many resources that a marketer can tap to uncover free leads:

- **Industry Association Websites**

Many industry associations keep extensive business directories of association members. These lists are often free and available for download. About.com [suggests](#) that you search "*industry name* association member business directory" and replace the italics with the specific industry in question.

- **Public Library**

Most local public libraries keep hard-copy business directories in the Reference section. Your reference librarian can point you in the right direction. In addition, your library may have a membership with certain online business directories, such as InfoUSA.com, SalesGenie or Hoover's. If so, you may be given free access to those sales lead lists.

- **Plunkett Research**

Plunkett creates almanacs and business data for various industries. Libraries may receive a special package that includes government agencies, individual consumers and various university contact information. Depending on your niche, this may be an invaluable resource for building your own sales lead list.

Plunkett Research boasts a client list of over [10,000 organizations worldwide](#), and by the company's estimate, each day over 20,000 people use the data that Plunkett releases.

- **DMOZ.org**

Also known as the [Open Directory Project](#), DMOZ.org is owned by AOL but run by volunteer editors across the world in an effort to create "the most comprehensive human edited directory of the Web."

Resource Description Framework (RDF) data dumps are available to download, which include large portions of the Open Directory. The site's administrators warn users that these files may be substantial. Be forewarned that your [browser may have difficulty](#) downloading the files.



Sales Leads Database

- **Experian**

The company best known for credit reports also has collected what it considers to be "the largest, most extensive [business-to-business](#) database in the industry." You can access the sales leads database after completing your free registration.

What makes this service free is similar to the take-a-penny-leave-a-penny trays at your local convenience store. You can access the leads for free as long as you provide your information for others to access.

- **InfoUSA**

If your local library doesn't have access to InfoUSA, you can pay for entry. Pricing starts at \$99, and is scalable based on the amount and depth of information sought. Users gain access to InfoUSA's "23 million business leads and [260 million consumer leads](#)."

- **Base**

On the personal storage and organization front, [Base](#) offers users a simple customer relations management (CRM) frontend to help manage a curated sales lead list. Boasting sales tracking and sales forecasting tools, you can run Base on your computer as well as iOS and android devices. Base offers a 14-day free trial and a tiered payment structure based on user count and feature selection.

Takeaway

Consider your options when building your own sales lead list. There are many free resources available to you

both digitally as well as at your local public library. While your niche may not be served by free business association listings, you may have better luck with paid sales lead lists. There is no silver bullet to building a great sales lead list, but with the resources available you should be able to get one going on the right foot.

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Hailing from Chicago and a product of the Illinois public school system, Chaz Wilke is a professional writer who has written for newspaper, TV, radio, video games, blogs, and film. In his spare time, Chaz enjoys hiking and discovering the hidden gems and oddities of Los Angeles. He also juggles.

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